

“If you have the time and energy and want to make extra money shoveling the driveway across the street, that decision is yours to make,” he said.

“That’s not what we want,” I blurted out. “We want a raise.” We wanted what the neighbor was offering: \$2.00 an hour, 50 cents more than we were getting paid by Mom and Dad. George laughed out loud and walked away. So my brother and I did what other frustrated workers around the world do: We went on strike. (Everyone’s a socialist when they’re young.) We stopped shoveling and went out with our friends to play in the snow.

Guess what? Our strategy worked! After a day or two, our parents negotiated our raise. Clearly, they valued not having to clean the driveway themselves, and I suspect, too, that they were trying to teach us a thing or two about money and the world of work.

We got a raise *and* worked a little overtime to help out the neighbor across the street. It was a lucrative month. (I only wish I had had the wherewithal to subcontract some of the shoveling out to friends. Now *that* would have been smart, *and* lucrative.)